I told him and he wrote it down. My first night in the Army—and I was on report.

I was quite philosophical about it. I had spent my whole life going on report—from grade school to the Navy Yard—and always for the same heinous crime, answering back.

Later that day, we had shots for tetanus and typhoid, and another physical examination, a very sketchy one. We had blood-type determinations and I turned out to be blood type B (which is every bit as rich as blood type O).

In the evening, I was turned loose. I found myself in a more formal uniform, which fitted reasonably well, and in a barracks with nothing to do but think. What I thought was: This is it for two years!

I was overwhelmed with such homesickness, with such an unbear-ble feeling of helpless imprisonment that for a few moments I thought I must collapse. I had to think of something and, bending my giant brain to the task, I realized that it was Friday and that somewhere on the post there had to be a chapel and that in it pretty soon there had to be Sabbath services.

I hadn't attended Sabbath services since I was eight, when my father had taken me, but I was in no mood to stand on principle. What I needed was companionship and something to do. So I went to chapel.

We recited Hebrew prayers and sang hymns. I couldn't manage the prayers, but I could sing hymns well enough, since I can match the notes of whoever stands next to me with almost no perceptible delay

and, after a while, I get the feel of the tune and can guess the next note. I was so relieved to be doing something other than standing in the empty passage between the barracks that my voice rang out thankfully and soared above the rest so that someone tapped me on the shoulder and asked me, eagerly, if I would care to lead the singing. I shook my head in terror and sang in a whisper thereafter.

After services we had salami on khallah (the traditional white egg-bread eaten on the Sabbath) and cake and tea. I got back to the barracks at ten-thirty and was tired enough to fall asleep at once.

I frequently felt homesick in the Army thereafter, but never, never quite as painfully as upon the end of that first full day, when I felt as though the whole world had forsaken me, that I was lost, and that no one would ever find me